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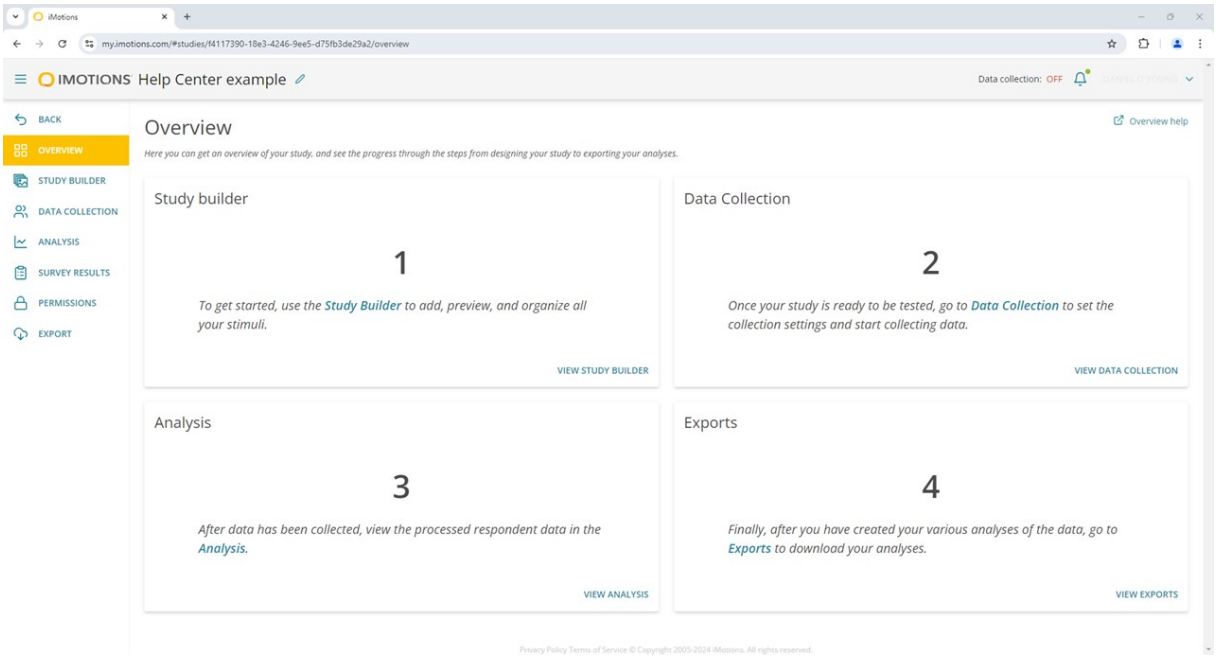
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Study builder - iMotions Online

This article explains each of the features associated with the study builder page on iMotions Online.

Overview

After creating/selecting an iMotions Online study you will see the Overview page, where you can navigate to the Study Builder page (with the leftmost panel):



Top: Along the very top of the screen, you can see the study title, which can be changed by clicking on the pencil icon next to it. You can also see whether or not data collection is live (i.e. if a link to study participants is active - this is explained more in the Data collection article). You can also access account information, and submit feedback, by clicking on your name in the top right.

Left side: On the left you are able to navigate through other study sections. Each of these are explained in detail within the following articles: Data collection, Analysis, Survey results, and Export.

Center: The center of the screen shows the stimuli that have been added to the study. The pre-study and post-study calibration (for webcam-based eye tracking) are added in automatically, and to ensure optimal eye tracking data quality, cannot be removed. It's possible to add additional stimuli by clicking on the "+ ADD STIMULI" button.

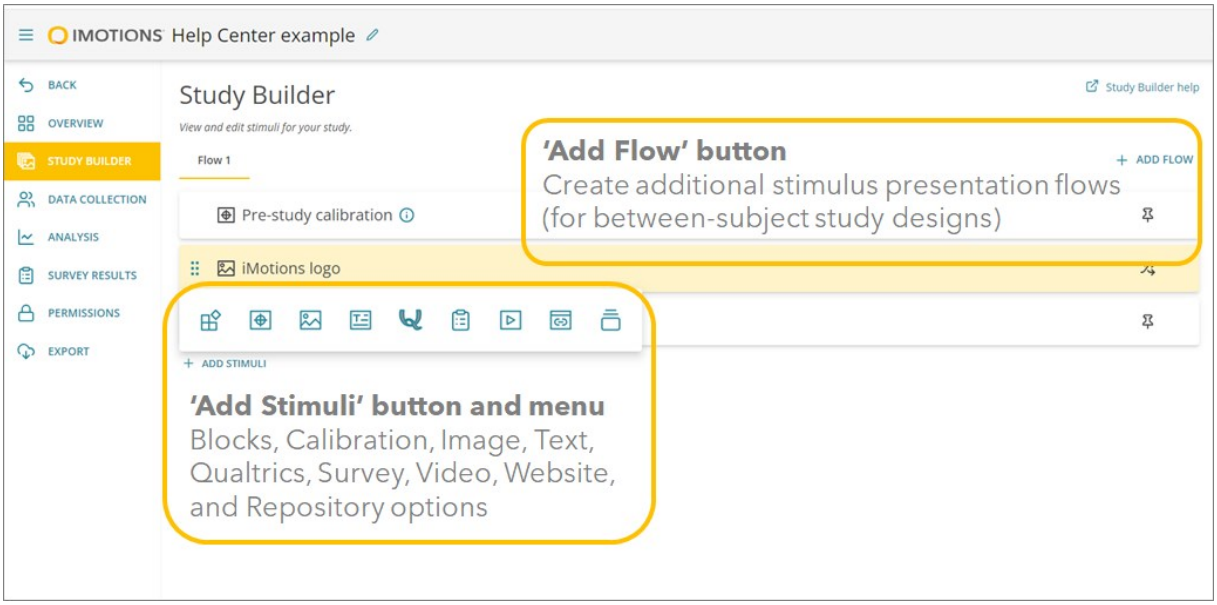
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Right side: The stimuli details and settings can be viewed on the right side of the screen. This will be explained in the "Stimuli in Study" section below.

Study Builder

Adding Stimuli and Flows

Once you click '+ ADD STIMULI' button you can begin adding stimuli to your study. You can also click the '+ ADD FLOW' button to create additional stimulus flows, as for between-subject designs.



iMotions Online Study Builder (with 'Add Stimuli' and 'Add Flows' buttons)

Block: With this option it's possible to insert blocks into your study design. A block can hold single or multiple instances of stimuli. These blocks can allow for a randomized sequence of stimuli within an otherwise controlled sequence of stimuli outside of the block (or vice versa).

Calibration: It's possible to add further calibration sequences to the study. While additional sequences can ensure optimal data quality, this can also become burdensome for participants. It is therefore generally only recommended to add further sequences in studies taking longer than 5-10 minutes.

Image: licking on the Image icon will reveal the capability to upload an image from your computer. You can also change the name of the image stimulus for your study here. Once you have uploaded and named your image, click "Add stimuli".

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Instruction: This option allows you to add an instruction slide to the study. You will be able to add text which will be shown as a stimulus during the study.

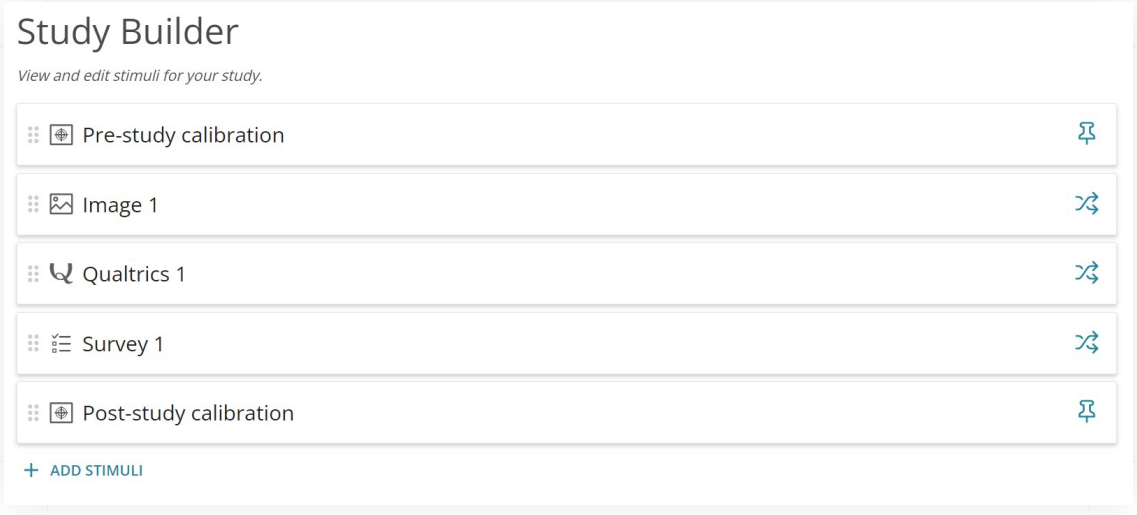
Qualtrics: It's possible to add Qualtrics surveys by adding a link. Note that you will require your own Qualtrics account, and a shareable survey for this to function. You can also name the survey here.

Survey: iMotions Online also provides a built-in survey creator. Click on "Add stimuli" to insert this into the study. This can then be created and edited by selecting it, and clicking on "edit survey" on the right-hand side of the screen. More information about this is provided in the Survey builder article.

Video: As with an image, it's possible to upload videos by clicking on "Select file". iMotions Online supports most of the popular formats for video files, however the video should be previewed prior to launch (see video settings below). Please note that the maximum recommended resolution for uploaded videos is 1920x1080. If the resolution is above these values, it may cause video buffering issues for participants without optimal internet connections. It is recommended that you lower the resolution in such cases, or it may affect the participants' data quality. You can also name the stimulus here. Click "Add stimuli" to continue.

Website: You can add a website here as a stimulus by entering the website address. You can also name the stimulus here.

Once you have added all of your desired stimuli, you can click on the dots to the left of each stimulus name, and drag them to reorder them. You can see on the right side of the stimulus whether or not the stimulus position is fixed (the pin icon) or random (the intertwined arrows icon) - this can be changed by clicking on each stimulus, which we will explain in the following section.



Stimulus Details menus

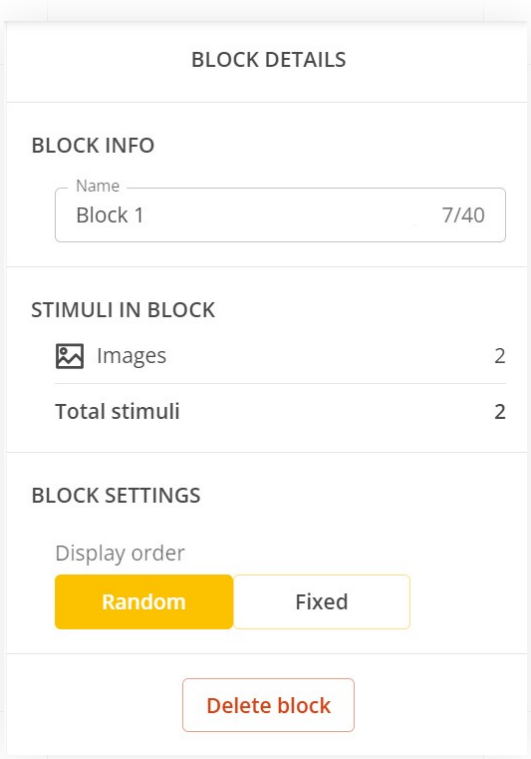
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The following section discusses the details and options available for each type of stimulus.

Block

Clicking on the block will add a stimuli block to the study. From here you can add any of the stimuli into the block, including additional blocks. The blocks provide control over sections of stimuli by allowing you to set their sequence, or to randomize them, outside of other stimuli.

Once you click on the block, you will be presented with a box containing information and adjustable options on the right-hand side of the page.



Name: The name of the block can be changed by writing in the "Name" text box.

Stimuli in block: This provides information regarding the number of total stimuli within the block. If a block is inserted within a block, the amount will be shown under "blocks in block" (it is therefore not counted as a stimulus).

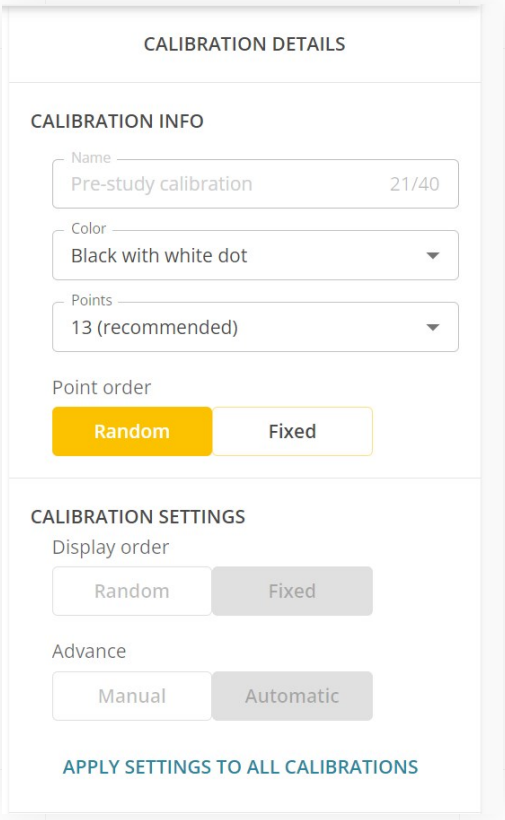
Display order: This allows you to determine if the stimuli within the block will be presented in a random order within the block, or if the position in which they are presented in is fixed.

Delete block: This will delete this specific block from the study.

Calibration slides

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Once you click on one of the calibration slides stimuli, you will be presented with a box containing information and adjustable options on the right-hand side of the page.



Name: It's not possible to change the stimuli names of the pre- or post-calibration slides. However, if you have added an additional calibration slide stimulus, you will be able to change the name here within the text box.

Color: The type of calibration colors used (black dots on a white screen, or white dots on a black screen) can be adjusted with the "Color" dropdown box. Generally, it is recommended that the screen colors between the calibration slides and the following stimulus match as closely as possible. This means that if a bright stimulus (such as an image) will be presented as the first stimulus, then the "black dots on a white screen" calibration slides would be preferred. More information about this is available in our webcam-based eye tracking white paper (available here), specifically on page 8: "Changes in light conditions".

Points: It's also possible to change the number of dots that will be used in the calibration, by selecting 9 or 13 from the "Points" dropdown box. While 13 are always recommended for optimal data quality, 9 points are quicker for the participant to view.

Points order: The order in which the dots appear can be adjusted by selecting Random or Fixed underneath "Point order".

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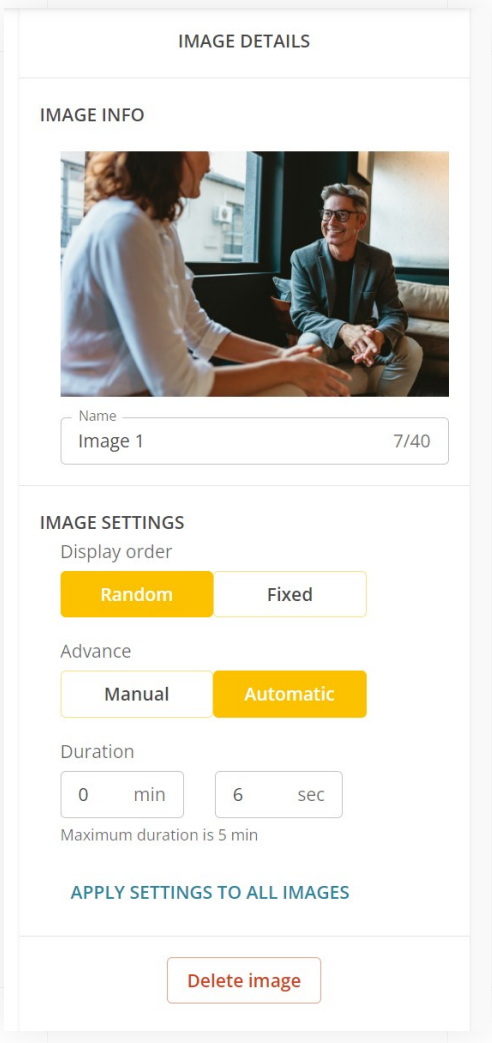
Display order: While this option is not adjustable for the pre- or post-calibration slides, it is possible to adjust the position of any additional calibration slides to be Random or Fixed.

Advance: All calibration slides are set to automatically advance once they are complete.

Apply settings to all calibrations: Clicking on this button will apply the above settings to all stimuli of this type (such as the color and number of the dots). It's also possible to delete any calibration slides that are not the mandatory pre- or post-calibration slides.

Image settings

Once you click on an image stimulus, you will be presented with a box containing information and adjustable options on the right-hand side of the page. The image stimulus itself will be shown as a preview - this is a good opportunity to quickly see if the stimulus is presented correctly.

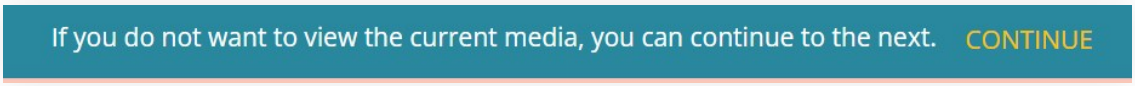


Name: The name of the stimulus can be changed by writing in the "Name" text box.

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Display order: This allows you to determine if the stimulus will be presented in a random order within the list of other stimuli, or if the position in which it is presented in is fixed.

Advance: This determines whether or not the participant will be able to manually advance from the stimulus. Manually advancing from the stimulus can be completed by clicking on "CONTINUE" on a banner that appears on top of the stimulus (shown in the image below).



Duration: You can change the stimulus exposure time here in minutes and seconds. The maximum duration is 5 minutes. Please note that if "Advance" is set to manual, it will be possible for the participant to progress to the next stimulus without necessarily viewing the stimulus for the desired duration.

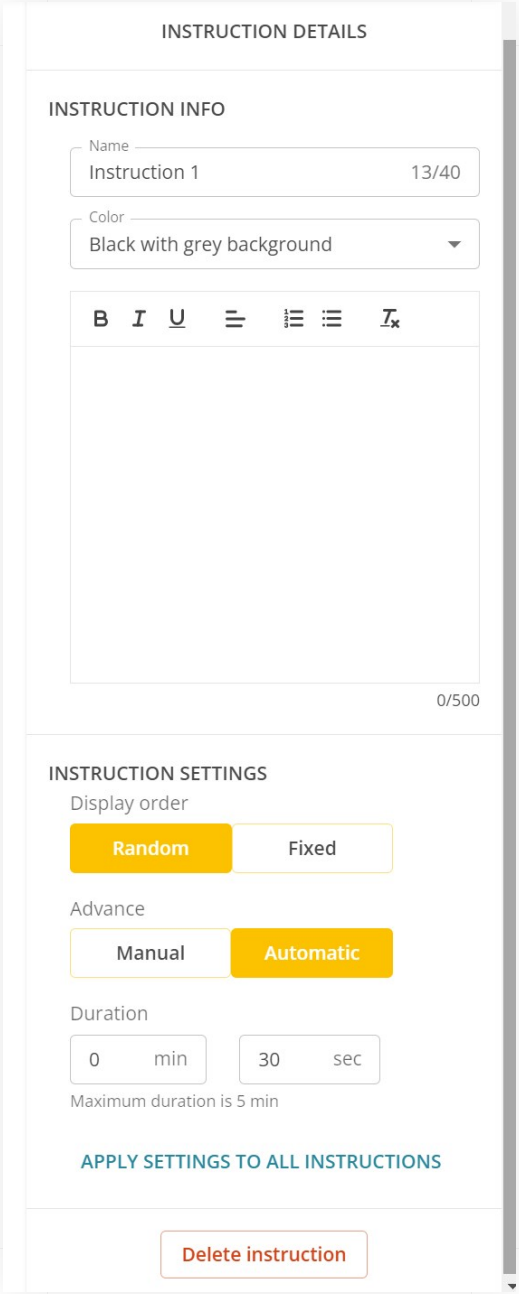
Apply settings to all images: Clicking on this button will apply the above settings to all stimuli of this type (such as the image duration and advance type).

Delete image: This will delete this specific image from the study.

Instruction settings:

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Once you click on an instruction stimulus, you will be presented with a box containing information and adjustable options on the right-hand side of the page.



Name: The name of the stimulus can be changed by writing in the "Name" text box.

Color: This allows you to change the appearance of the text on the screen. The options are as follows (with the first color denoting the text):

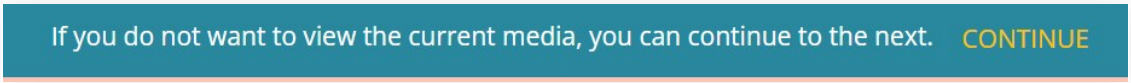
- Black with grey background
- Black with white background
- White with black background

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Text box: Below the "color" settings, you will find a text box with some rich text editing capabilities. Here you can add text information that you would like to present to the participant. This could be, for example, a prompt to look for a certain item in an image, instructions to focus on an element in a video, or any information that you would like to convey or show during the study.

Display order: This allows you to determine if the stimulus will be presented in a random order within the list of other stimuli, or if the position in which it is presented in is fixed.

Advance: This determines whether or not the participant will be able to manually advance from the stimulus. Manually advancing from the stimulus can be completed by clicking on "CONTINUE" on a banner that appears on top of the stimulus (shown in the image below).



Duration: You can change the stimulus exposure time here in minutes and seconds. The maximum duration is 5 minutes. Please note that if "Advance" is set to manual, it will be possible for the participant to progress to the next stimulus without necessarily viewing the stimulus for the desired duration.

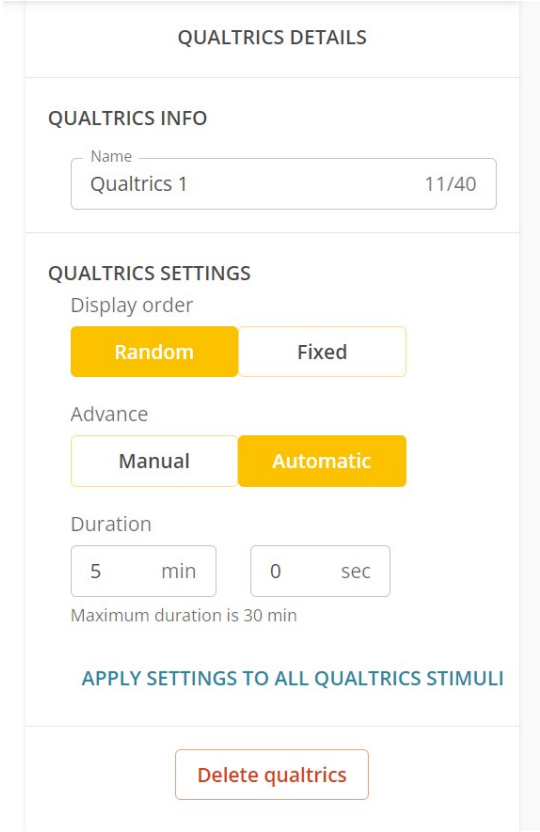
Apply settings to all instructions: Clicking on this button will apply the above settings (such as the color and advance type) to all instruction slides in the study. It will not affect the content of other text boxes.

Delete instruction: This will delete this specific instruction stimulus from the study.

Qualtrics settings:

Once you click on a Qualtrics stimulus, you will be presented with a box containing information and adjustable options on the right-hand side of the page. The options presented below only allow for adjustments related to the survey within iMotions - to change settings related to the survey itself you will need to be logged in to your Qualtrics account.

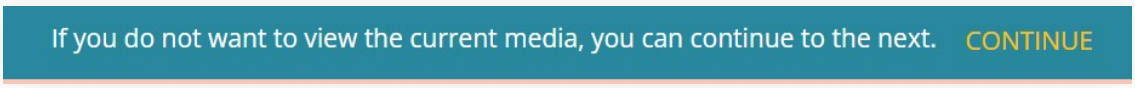
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Name: The name of the stimulus can be changed by writing in the "Name" text box.

Display order: This allows you to determine if the stimulus will be presented in a random order within the list of other stimuli, or if the position in which it is presented in is fixed.

Advance: This determines whether or not the participant will be able to manually advance from the stimulus. Manually advancing from the stimulus can be completed by clicking on "CONTINUE" on a banner that appears on top of the stimulus (shown in the image below).



Duration: You can change the stimulus exposure time here in minutes and seconds. The maximum duration is 5 minutes. Please note that if "Advance" is set to manual, it will be possible for the participant to progress to the next stimulus without necessarily viewing the stimulus for the desired duration.

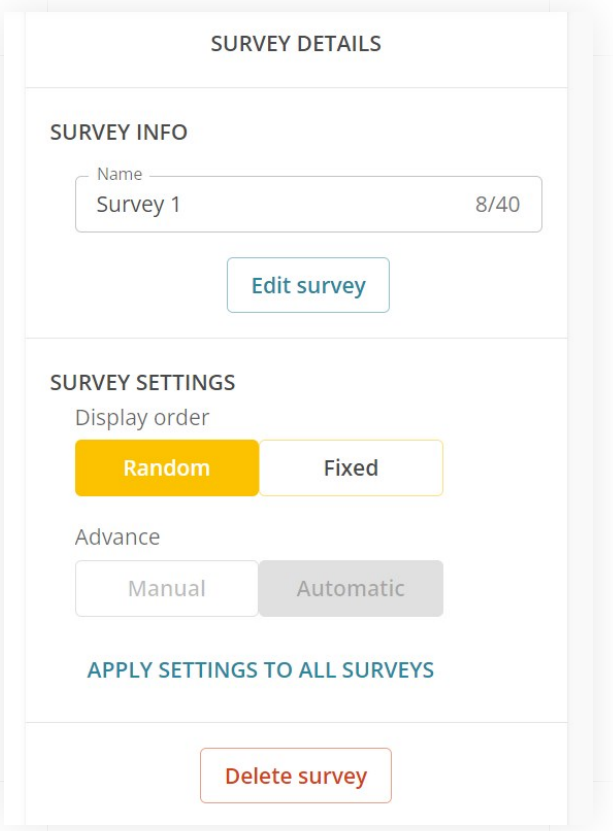
Apply settings to all Qualtrics stimuli: Clicking on this button will apply the above settings to all stimuli of this type.

Delete Qualtrics: This will delete this specific Qualtrics-linked survey from the study.

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Survey settings

Once you click on a Survey stimulus, you will be presented with a box containing information and adjustable options on the right-hand side of the page.



Name: The name of the stimulus can be changed by writing in the "Name" text box.

Edit survey: Please see this article for complete information about how to create and edit a survey using iMotions' built-in survey editor.

Display order: This allows you to determine if the survey will be presented in a random order within the list of other stimuli, or if the position in which it is presented in is fixed.

Advance: The settings are not adjustable here. The survey will advance once the participant has completed the survey.

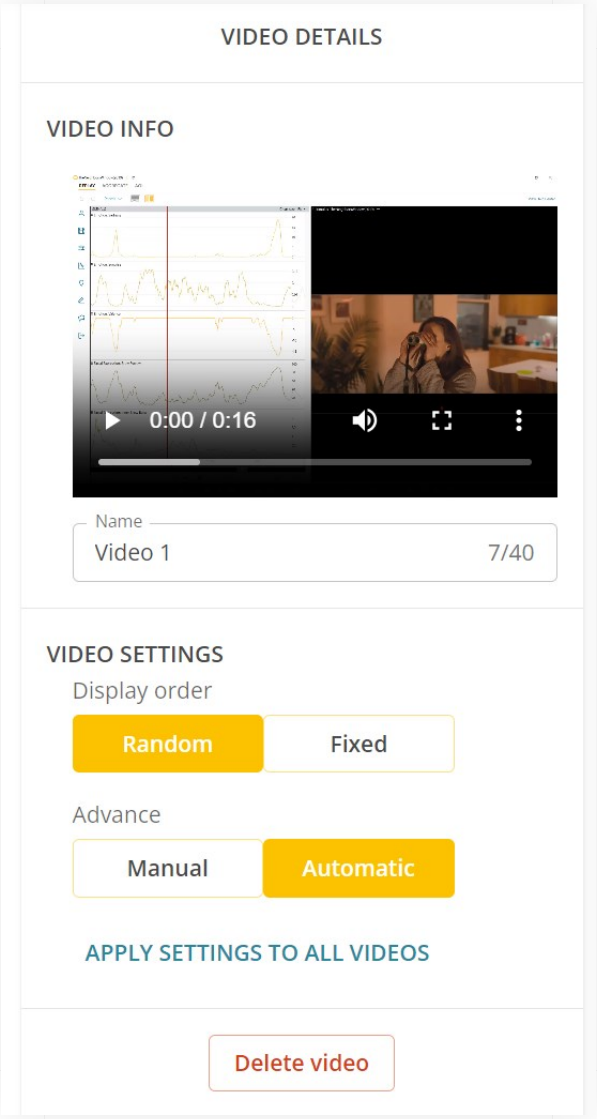
Apply settings to all surveys: Clicking on this button will apply the above settings (i.e. the display order type) to all surveys.

Delete survey: This will delete this specific survey from the study.

Video settings

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Once you click on a video stimulus, you will be presented with a box containing information and adjustable options on the right-hand side of the page. Here you will also see a preview of the video. It is recommended that you inspect and play this to ensure that the video upload worked correctly.

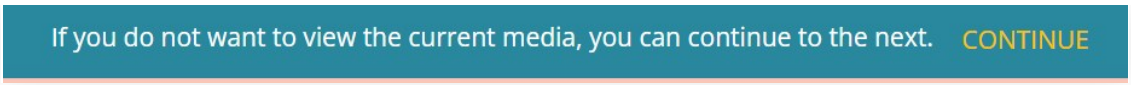


Name: The name of the stimulus can be changed by writing in the "Name" text box.

Display order: This allows you to determine if the video will be presented in a random order within the list of other stimuli, or if the position in which it is presented in is fixed.

Advance: This determines whether or not the participant will be able to manually advance from the stimulus. Manually advancing from the stimulus can be completed by clicking on "CONTINUE" on a banner that appears on top of the stimulus (shown in the image below).

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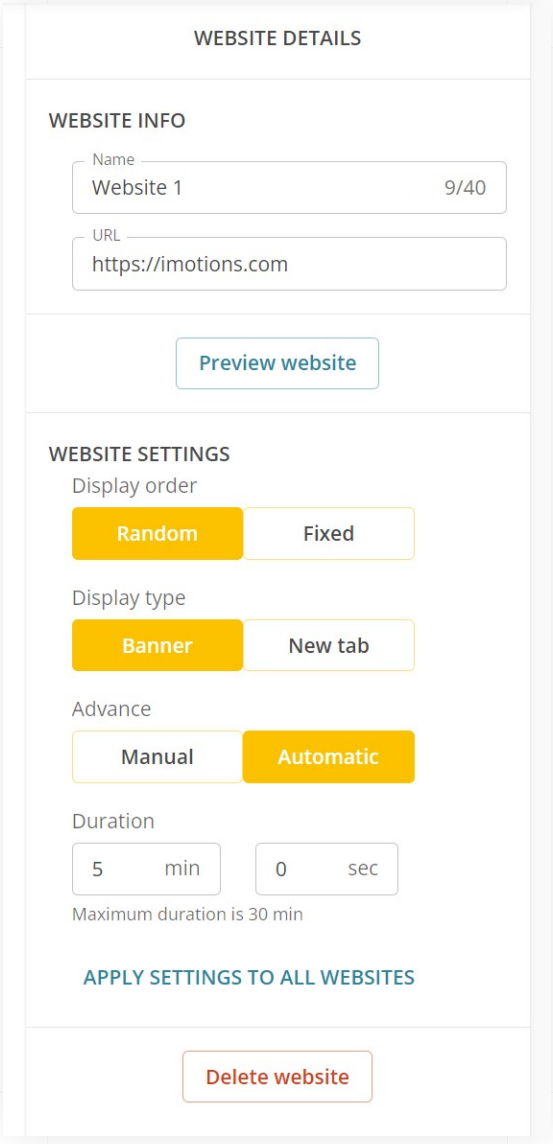
If automatic is selected, the next stimulus will simply appear once the video is finished.

Apply settings to all videos: Clicking on this button will apply the above settings (i.e. the display order and advance type) to all videos in the study.

Delete video: This will delete this specific video from the study.

Website settings

Once you click on a website stimulus, you will be presented with a box containing information and adjustable options on the right-hand side of the page.



Name: The name of the stimulus can be changed by writing in the "Name" text box.

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URL: You can enter or edit the URL (i.e. the web address) here as the desired stimulus.

Preview website: It is strongly recommended that you preview the website by clicking this button. This will allow you to check if the website appears and performs as intended. It is recommended that users and participants use Chrome when creating or completing an iMotions Online study. It is also recommended to use this option once you have selected the display type, to ensure that the website functions correctly within a banner or tab.

Display order: This allows you to determine if the video will be presented in a random order within the list of other stimuli, or if the position in which it is presented in is fixed.

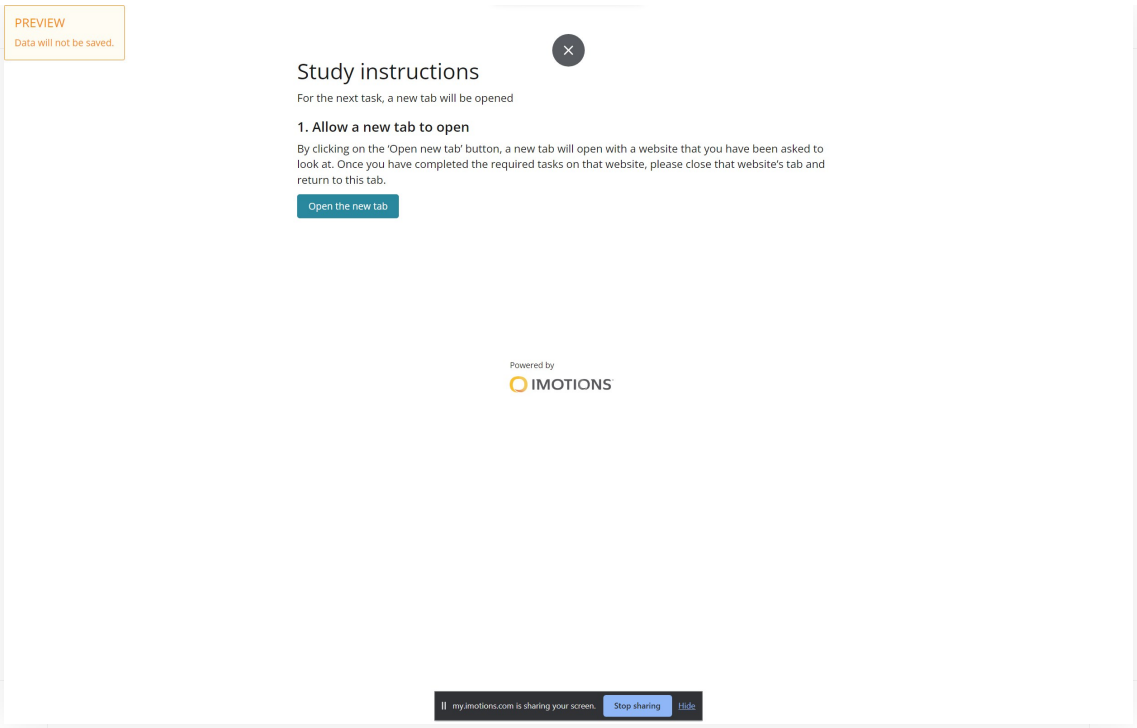
Display type: Selecting "banner" means that the website will ultimately be displayed within a box (an iFrame) - however the view of the participant should be the same as when viewing the website naturally. This is the simplest option for presenting to participants as the study remains within the same browser tab. It is also possible to set "Advance" and "Duration" settings with the banner option selected.

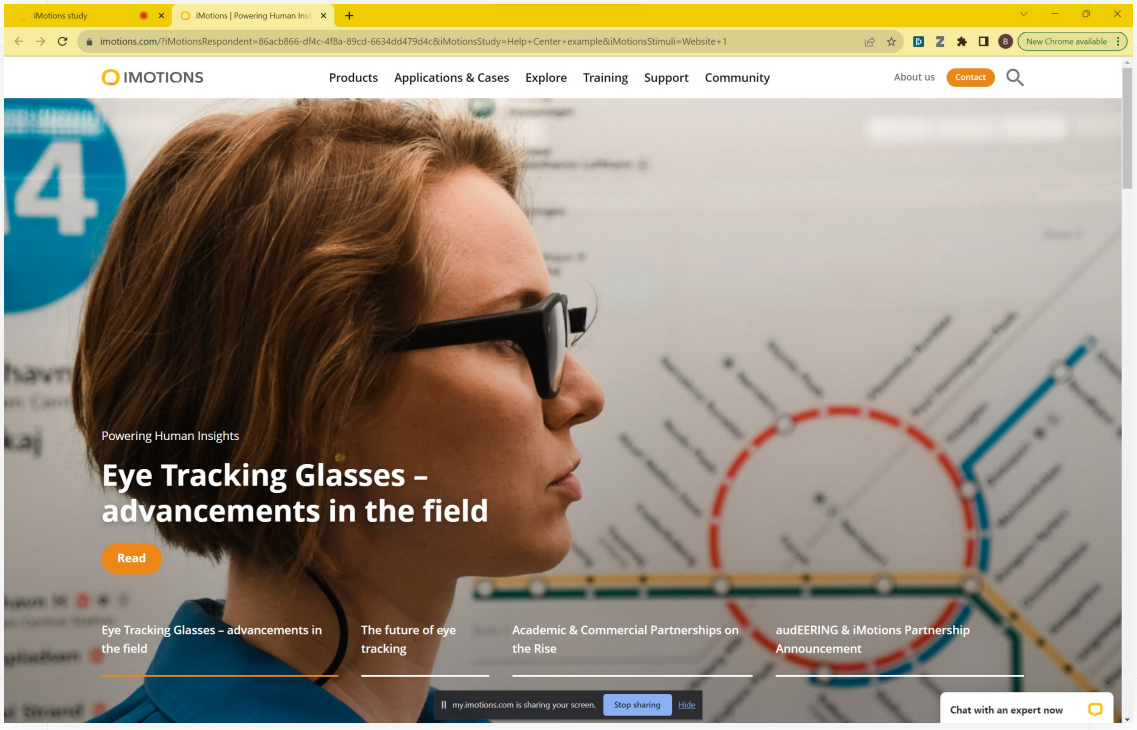
Selecting the "tab" option means that the website will be displayed in a new tab, outside of iMotions Online. iMotions Online can will continue to perform webcam-based eye tracking and screen recording for the new tab. Participants will receive a request to open a new tab, and they will be taken out of the full-screen view. This also means that the participant will have to return to the iMotions Online tab once they have finished viewing the website. It is not possible to set "Advance" or "Duration" settings with the tab option selected.

The sequence of screens that the participant is presented with for the tab option are shown below:

1. The participant is first requested to permit a new tab to open.

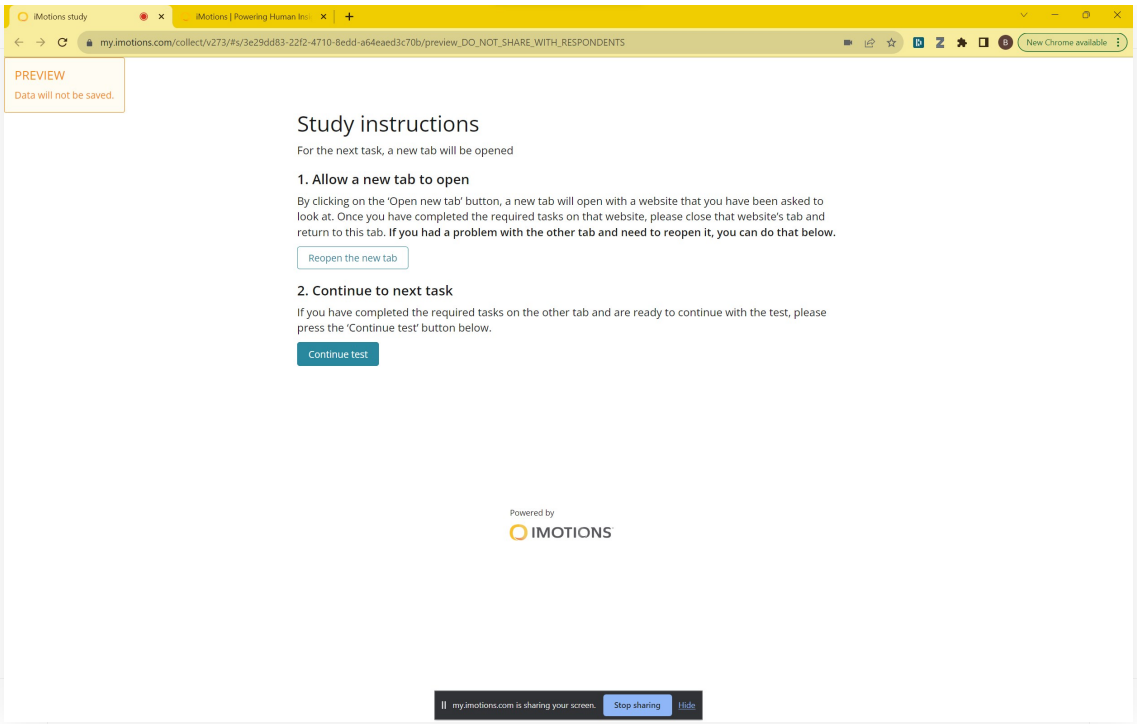
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2. The new tab appears - note that the study has now left the full-screen view.

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3. Once the participant has left the test tab, they are presented with the iMotions Online tab that asks if they would like to reopen the tab (in case it was accidentally closed), or if they would like to continue to the next task.

It is recommended that you preview the website after selecting this option to ensure functionality.

Advance: This determines whether or not the participant will be able to manually advance from the stimulus. Manually advancing from the stimulus can be completed by clicking on "CONTINUE" on a banner that appears on top of the stimulus (shown in the image below).

Duration: You can change the stimulus exposure time here in minutes and seconds. The maximum duration is 5 minutes. Please note that if "Advance" is set to manual, it will be possible for the participant to progress to the next stimulus without necessarily viewing the stimulus for the desired duration.

Final steps

It is recommended that you have done the following before proceeding:

- Previewed all stimuli.
- Ensured that all settings, such as the display type, and duration, are as desired.
- Ensured that the order of the stimuli is as desired.

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You should now proceed to the Data collection tab in iMotions Online.

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